

Google Customer Engineer Interview Prep

Resources

1. Cloud Fundamentals & AWS → GCP Mapping

Goal

Understand equivalent services, migration patterns, and cloud-native thinking.

Topics Covered

- AWS vs GCP core services
- Compute, storage, networking mappings
- IAM concepts
- Managed Kubernetes
- Serverless ecosystem
- Migration architecture patterns
- Multi-cloud thinking

Resources

AWS → GCP Mapping Guides

- [Compare AWS and Azure services to Google Cloud | Get started](#)

GCP Fundamentals

-  Top 40 Google Cloud Services In 30 MINUTES [Full Guide]

IAM & Networking

-  AWS IAM Core Concepts You NEED to Know

Cloud Migration Patterns

- [The 7 R's of Cloud Migration | IBM](#)
- [What is cloud migration? Strategy and process](#)

Multi-Cloud / Vendor Lock-In

- [Vendor lock-in and cloud computing | Cloudflare](#)

Architecture Best Practices

- [General best practices | Cloud Architecture Center](#)
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2. Kubernetes Preparation

Goal

Prepare enough Kubernetes depth for CE-level discussions.

Topics Covered

- Pods / Deployments / Services
- Ingress
- Scaling
- Stateful vs Stateless
- Helm basics
- Kubernetes networking
- Troubleshooting basics
- GKE understanding

Resources

Kubernetes Course

-  Complete Kubernetes Course - From BEGINNER to PRO

CKA-style Learning Resources

- [Certified Kubernetes Administrator Full Course For beginners | CKA 2025 - YouTube](#)

Kubernetes Networking

-  Kubernetes Networking Explained

GKE-Specific Concepts

- [Google Kubernetes Engine - YouTube](#)

Kubernetes Troubleshooting

- https://youtube.com/playlist?list=PLdpzxOOAlwvIrFBI1farplS_OSUBXJMLX&si=U_zJv975nzPWj4ao
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3. System Design Basics

Goal

Learn enough system design to communicate architecture clearly.

Topics Covered

- High-level architecture thinking
- Scalability basics
- Reliability
- Stateless design
- Load balancing

- Caching
- Databases
- Trade-offs

Resources

System Design Crash Course:

-  System Design Concepts CRASH COURSE For Beginners | End-To-End DevOp...

4. Customer Engineering Thinking

Goal

Learn how Customer Engineers communicate and frame problems.

Topics Covered

- Discovery conversations
- Technical storytelling
- Translating business → technical
- Executive communication
- Trade-off discussions
- Objection handling
- Recommendation framing

Resources

- [Inside Google Cloud: Enterprise Sales & Customer Engineering](#)
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5. Cloud Migration & Trade-Off Analysis

Goal

Prepare for scenario-based architecture questions.

Topics Covered

- On-prem → cloud
 - AWS → GCP migration
 - Vendor lock-in concerns
 - Open-source strategies
 - Cost optimization
 - Hybrid architecture
 - Multi-cloud patterns
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6. Behavioral / GCA Preparation

Goal

Prepare structured stories and thinking frameworks.

Topics Covered

- Conflict resolution
- Ambiguity handling
- Customer dissatisfaction
- Leadership
- Ownership
- Collaboration
- Communication under pressure

Resources

STAR Method

- <https://capd.mit.edu/resources/the-star-method-for-behavioral-interviews/>

Leadership Story Preparation

- https://www.reddit.com/r/ExperiencedDevs/comments/1fo7urw/how_many_stories_do_you_prepare_for_behavioral/

Ambiguity & Decision Making

- [What Questions Are Asked in a Google Behavioral Interview? | by Kei Zee | Medium](#)
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7. Presentation Round Preparation

Goal

Prepare mock customer presentations.

Topics Covered

- Business + technical audiences
 - Assumption-led communication
 - Customer pain framing
 - Simplifying technical concepts
 - Whiteboarding
 - Presentation structure
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8. Cost & Architecture Trade-Offs

Goal

Prepare for recommendation-level discussions.

Topics Covered

- Cost vs performance
- Build vs buy
- Managed vs self-hosted
- Scalability trade-offs
- Reliability trade-offs
- Operational complexity

Resources

Cloud Cost Optimization

- [Architecture strategies for optimizing code costs - Microsoft Azure Well-Architected Framework](#)
- [Build vs. buy - A strategic framework for evaluating third-party solutions](#)
- [Self-Managed vs Managed Hosting: Which One Should You Choose?](#)

Trade-Off Frameworks

- [Top 5 Trade-offs in System Designs](#)
- [Top Strategies to Improve Reliability in Distributed Systems](#)

Architecture Decision Making

- [ADR process - AWS Prescriptive Guidance](#)

FinOps Basics

- [What is Cloud FinOps?](#)
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9. Mock Interviews & Practice

Goal

Simulate real interview pressure.

Practice Areas

- Thinking out loud
 - Architecture walkthroughs
 - Customer conversations
 - Executive communication
 - Trade-off reasoning
 - Behavioral storytelling
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10. Final Preparation Checklist

Week Before Interview

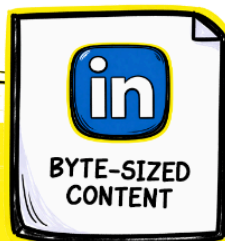
- ☐ Revise AWS ↔ GCP mappings
- ☐ Practice 5 architecture scenarios
- ☐ Practice executive communication
- ☐ Prepare 5 STAR stories
- ☐ Practice explaining one complex topic simply
- ☐ Review migration trade-offs
- ☐ Practice customer discovery questions
- ☐ Conduct mock interviews
- ☐ Practice thinking out loud
- ☐ Review cost optimization frameworks

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